1954–55. The US Navy sailed into the straits to end the mounting conflict, and Eisenhower threatened to use nuclear weapons against the mainland.

In sum, by the mid-1950s, just as India was growing closer to the two superpowers, China was in conflict with both of them. The split with the USSR was not altogether public, but it was gathering strength. With the US, China had nearly once again come to the point of war, this time over Taiwan.

The India–China–USSR entente

Washington and Moscow may not have liked non-alignment, but the posture allowed India to develop relatively friendly ties with both the US and the USSR. Until 1956, when the first reports of Chinese road-building in Aksai Chin surfaced, Delhi was close to Beijing as well. On balance, India was more comfortable with the Soviets and China during this period than with America. US anti-communism and its support for Pakistan made life awkward for India and translated into at least two key problems. The first was Delhi's struggles with getting the US to provide developmental aid and invest in India's industrialization. Washington was reluctant to commit funds to a planned socialist economy and remained fairly deaf to Indian requests. The second problem was Delhi's inability to buy American weaponry. Washington's refusal to sell advanced military systems arose from its concerns over US alliance commitments to Pakistan.[3] Relations were further complicated by India's attempts to persuade the Anglo-American powers to accommodate the communist powers in the interests of international stability. Delhi's equivocations on the Soviet intervention in the Hungarian revolt in 1956 and support for mainland China to replace Taiwan as a permanent member of the UN Security Council added to America's unhappiness. In 1955, despite uneasiness in the US (and UK), Delhi helped organize a summit in Bandung to which China as well as several Asian and African countries were invited. Nehru was keen to build